  - — NAFTA (North American Free Trade Agreement—the United States, Canada, and Mexico), a bloc of 360 million people with a GDP of $6 trillion
  - — APEC (Asia-Pacific Economic Cooperation), the Pacific bloc
  - — the EC (European Community), the Common Market, a bloc of 360 million people
- China slowly and surely rose to become a superpower that would skip over Russia and compete with the United States.
- The world experienced both a consolidation into various blocs and a fragmentation into ethnic and tribal units.
- The world became one of regional conflicts.
- The UN, which had succeeded in the enacting of sanctions, failed in the resolution of conflicts.
- The Gulf War accelerated some far-reaching changes:
  - — A vast international coalition was created.
  - — In this coalition, Arabs fought against other Arabs, thereby putting an end to the vision of pan-Arabism.
  - — Only one global superpower took part in the Gulf War.
  - — It was a war in which Western weapons had absolute superiority.
  - — It was a war that proved that strategic depth was no match for strategic weapons.
- The fall of the Soviet Union and the Gulf War spurred the Middle East peace process. Over the course of 1993, there were three parallel Israeli diplomatic initiatives vis-à-vis two Arab states—Jordan and Syria—and the PLO (the Oslo process).
- The Iran-Iraq War that ended in 1988 and the First Gulf War in 1991 convinced Iran to enter the race toward nonconventional weapons, making the issue of proliferation and the danger of a nuclear Iran the central priority of our Essential Elements of Information (EEI), as well as those of other intelligence services.
- The phenomenon of Muslim fundamentalism, which expressed the Arab dream to return to the glory days of Islam, was on the rise.